PantryPulse action plan: Texas

Generated September 26, 2026 by Claude. Requires human approval before any action. Units: households per week; food in lbs; money in USD.

Summary

Texas faces two risk surges (weeks of 10/19-10/26 and a bigger one 11/16) driven mainly by Tarrant, Harris, Galveston, Johnson, Cameron and Wichita counties, with Tarrant and Johnson and Wichita and Liberty hitting RED status by 11/16. Suggested county-to-county transfers (Dallas, Hidalgo, Travis, Collin, Williamson, Montgomery, Bell, Nueces surplus counties) can cover most gaps before any new volunteer or food asks are needed. Texas unemployment (4.4%, +0.2pt YoY) and food inflation (2.7% YoY) are both edging up, so we should plan toward the high end of forecasts and treat funding/food asks as conservative minimums.

Key numbers (next 8 weeks)

Counties at risk	Households over capacity	Extra food (lbs)	Extra meals	Funding gap	Extra volunteer shifts	Covered by transfers
98 of 253	3,358	100,740	83,950	$286,142	388	2,797

Priorities

#	County	Week of	Recommended action	Why	Owner	Deadline	Approved
1	Tarrant County, Texas	2026-09-28	Activate Dallas-to-Tarrant transfer (99 households/week, 2,970 lbs food) and add 4 volunteer shifts	Earliest alert, start_outreach_by ASAP; gap of 99 households, short on volunteers and food	Agency relations	2026-09-28	
2	Tarrant County, Texas	2026-10-19	Confirm Dallas-to-Tarrant transfer (205 households/week, 6,150 lbs) and recruit 9 extra volunteer shifts	Largest near-term gap (205 households) in the 10/19 surge week; outreach must start by 10/05	Volunteer coordinator	2026-10-05	
3	Harris County, Texas	2026-10-19	Set up Dallas-to-Harris transfer (41 households/week, 1,230 lbs) and add 2 volunteer shifts	Gap of 41 households; outreach must start by 10/05	Agency relations	2026-10-05	
4	Galveston County, Texas	2026-10-19	Add 2 volunteer shifts and 900 lbs food sourcing (no transfer yet listed for this week)	Gap of 30 households, short on volunteers and food; outreach must start by 10/05	Warehouse lead	2026-10-05	
5	Tarrant County, Texas	2026-10-26	Activate Hidalgo-to-Tarrant (204 hh/wk, 6,120 lbs) plus Dallas-to-Tarrant (58 hh/wk, 1,740 lbs) transfers and recruit 11 volunteer shifts	Gap grows to 262 households, largest single-week gap before the 11/16 spike; outreach by 10/12	Agency relations	2026-10-12	

#	County	Week of	Recommended action	Why	Owner	Deadline	Approved
6	Multiple (Tarrant, Harris, Johnson, Wichita, Liberty)	2026-11-16	Pre-position transfers from Dallas, Hidalgo, Travis, Collin, Williamson, Montgomery, Bell and Nueces counties (totaling up to 483 hh/wk into Harris/Tarrant) and launch emergency volunteer and fundraising drives for RED-status Tarrant, Johnson, Wichita and Liberty counties	Largest week of the planning window: 98 counties at risk, 1,631 gap households, $137,897 funding gap; four counties hit RED status	Executive director	2026-11-02	

Move spare capacity first

Week of	From	To	Households/week	Food (lbs)	Note
2026-09-28	Dallas County, Texas	Tarrant County, Texas	99	2970	Covers Tarrant ASAP alert
2026-10-19	Dallas County, Texas	Tarrant County, Texas	205	6150	Covers full Tarrant gap for this week
2026-10-19	Dallas County, Texas	Harris County, Texas	41	1230	Covers Harris gap for this week
2026-10-26	Hidalgo County, Texas	Tarrant County, Texas	204	6120	Primary Tarrant transfer for the week
2026-10-26	Dallas County, Texas	Tarrant County, Texas	58	1740	Secondary transfer to close remaining Tarrant gap
2026-10-26	Dallas County, Texas	Harris County, Texas	125	3750	Covers most of Harris gap
2026-10-26	Travis County, Texas	Harris County, Texas	83	2490	Closes remaining Harris gap
2026-11-16	Dallas County, Texas	Harris County, Texas	185	5550	Largest single transfer for peak week

Draft outreach

Audience	County	Channel	Message
Volunteers	Tarrant County, Texas	SMS	Urgent: Tarrant County needs extra shift coverage the weeks of 9/28, 10/19, 10/26 and 11/9 to meet rising demand. Sign up for an extra shift today.
Donors	Harris County, Texas	Email	Harris County faces a growing funding gap heading into mid-November ($43,095 by 11/16). Your gift now helps us close the gap before the holiday surge.
Community partners	Multiple RED counties (Tarrant, Johnson, Wichita, Liberty)	Email	Four counties are projected to reach RED status by the week of 11/16. Please help coordinate local volunteer and food resources ahead of this surge.

Audience	County	Channel	Message
Volunteers	Galveston County, Texas	Social	Galveston County needs additional volunteer shifts starting the week of 10/19 through mid-November. Join us to help neighbors facing food insecurity.

Watch list

• King County, Texas: Possibly underserved with 0.0 weekly reach despite food insecurity rate of 23.3%
• Kenedy County, Texas: Possibly underserved with 0.0 weekly reach and highest food insecurity rate in list (34.7%)
• Foard County, Texas: Possibly underserved, very low weekly reach (0.0153)
• Terrell County, Texas: Possibly underserved, very low weekly reach (0.0153)
• Comanche County, Texas: Possibly underserved, low weekly reach (0.016)
• Mason County, Texas: Possibly underserved, low weekly reach (0.016)
• Freestone County, Texas: Possibly underserved, low weekly reach (0.0162)
• Yoakum County, Texas: Possibly underserved, low weekly reach (0.0163)
• Wheeler County, Texas: Possibly underserved, low weekly reach (0.017)
• Culberson County, Texas: Possibly underserved, low weekly reach (0.017) and food insecurity rate 27.7%

Risks and caveats

• Texas unemployment rose to 4.4% (up 0.2pt year-over-year) and food price inflation is 2.7% YoY, both pointing toward demand tracking the high end of forecasts used in these alerts.
• The week of 11/16 shows a sharp escalation (98 counties at risk, $137,897 funding gap, 1,631 gap households) versus the prior week (32 counties, $16,251) - this is the single largest capacity risk in the planning window and four counties (Tarrant, Johnson, Wichita, Liberty) are projected to hit RED status.
• Suggested transfers rely on donor counties (Dallas, Hidalgo, Travis, Collin, Williamson, Montgomery, Bell, Nueces) having stable surplus capacity; any shortfall in those counties would directly increase the funding and volunteer gap in recipient counties.
• Possibly underserved rural counties (rural_urban_code 9) have very low weekly reach (as low as 0.0) and are not captured in the top_alerts list, so real need there may be masked by the model's focus on larger at-risk counties.

Need data: Feeding America Map the Meal Gap (2019-2024) and USDA SNAP households by state. Weekly visits and capacity are simulated for this prototype. Numbers are computed by the forecasting model; the AI writes the plan but does not calculate figures.